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CS 5388

Festivo: Sprint 3 Contradiction Memo

1. Financial Planning and Budgeting

Assumption from Sprint 1:

We assumed that basic budget estimates would be sufficient for the initial version of Festivo. Advanced budgeting and expense splitting were deferred to future development, while direct payment processing was excluded from the MVP.

Contradicting Evidence:

- Interview 1 highlighted the importance of cost when coordinating travel for a wedding, including how expenses were managed among participants.
- Interview 3 discussed the costs associated with hosting an event, estimating expenses between $100 and $300.
- Our Partiful teardown revealed existing functionality for paid tickets and cost sharing, including links to external payment services.

Implications and Recommended Adjustments:

Financial coordination may be more important to event planning than we initially considered. While our interviews do not establish a need for direct payment processing, they highlight the importance of managing event expenses, and Partiful demonstrates that financial features already exist in competing platforms. We should reconsider the priority of budgeting and contribution tracking while keeping direct payment processing outside the MVP.

2. Invitation and RSVP Functionality as a Competitive Advantage

Assumptions from sprints 1 and 2:

We considered centralized invitation creation, distribution, and RSVP tracking to be important features that would distinguish Festivo from traditional planning methods. Guest coordination was then selected as one of our two major functional areas for project estimation.

Contradicting Evidence:

- During the Partiful teardown, we successfully created an event, shared an invitation, submitted an RSVP, and verified that the response appeared on the organizer's side.
- Partiful also provided guest-management controls, event customization, and additional coordination features.

Implications and Recommended Adjustments:

Although invitations and RSVP tracking remain essential to Festivo, our research showed that these features alone will not distinguish us from existing competitors. We should focus on how guest coordination integrates with vendor discovery, resource estimates, and other planning activities, emphasizing the convenience of managing these responsibilities through one platform.

3. Target Audience and Event Types

Assumption from Sprint 1

Our initial project concept focused primarily on planning parties and small social gatherings. Although the project scope included other events, much of our early research and project framing centered on party planning.

Contradicting Evidence:

- Interview 1 described coordinating travel arrangements for a wedding.
- Interview 2 discussed preparing decorations and arranging services for a birthday celebration.
- Our Partiful teardown demonstrated event creation using a graduation as the example.
- These examples involved different types of events but shared similar coordination needs.

Implications and Recommended Adjustments:

Our research reinforced that the planning challenges Festivo addresses are not exclusive to parties. Scheduling, guest coordination, vendor research, and budgeting can apply to many types of events. I believe we should broaden how we position Festivo to appeal to organizers of weddings, graduations, and other small to medium-sized events without significantly expanding the current MVP scope.

Assumptions

One of our earlier assumptions for Festivo was that a major difficulty in event planning is finding vendors, party supplies, venues, and other services across different websites or locations. Because of this, the original concept placed significant emphasis on centralized vendor discovery. A second assumption was that Festivo could focus on planning and budgeting without needing direct payment or ticketing functionality.

Evidence

In **Interview 1**, the participant helped coordinate transportation for a family wedding and identified cost as the biggest concern. The participant also described how group expenses are often divided informally. Vendor discovery was not a major issue. **Interview 2** provided the strongest support for vendor discovery. The participant helped with a family birthday and described searching different stores for decorations while relying on personal contacts for table and chair rentals. This shows that finding supplies can require several separate sources, but established vendor relationships can also reduce the need for a new discovery tool. **Interview 3** focused more on attendance uncertainty. The participant explained that not knowing how many people will attend can affect food, drinks, supplies, and preparation. Invitations and guest coordination appeared more important than finding vendors. Across all three interviews, participants relied on separate tools and methods such as Expedia, Canva, physical stores, rental contacts, invitations, and informal communication. None used one complete event-planning platform. Competitor research also introduces another contradiction. Partiful supports paid event tickets and allows hosts to collect ticket revenue and receive payouts. This could allow us as a team to implement features that will be unlocked once a certain fee or tier of the app has been paid. This would provide revenue for the app and provide more exclusive features.

Why This Matters

The evidence suggests that Festivo should not be positioned mainly as a vendor-discovery application. Users experience several connected problems involving attendance, invitations, budgeting, expense coordination, scheduling, transportation, supplies, and communication. Partiful's payment and ticketing capabilities also create a competitive risk. If users expect event platforms to support both planning and collecting money, Festivo could appear less complete. However, adding direct payments would also increase technical scope, security requirements, refund and dispute handling, and project risk. The interviews also suggest that Festivo should be positioned around events in general rather than only parties. The interviews involved a wedding, a family birthday, and a Halloween gathering, showing that the same coordination problems apply across different event types.

Recommendation

Festivo should be positioned as a centralized event-planning and coordination platform. Core features should continue to include vendor discovery, but equal or greater emphasis should be placed on RSVP tracking, invitations, scheduling, budgeting, shared expenses, centralized event information, and resource estimates based on attendance. For financial functionality, Festivo should initially support budgeting, contribution tracking, and possibly links to external payment services. Direct ticket sales, payment processing, refunds, and host payouts should remain deferred until additional research shows that they are necessary.

Conclusion

The Sprint 3 interviews show that the original Festivo concept was too narrow. Vendor discovery remains useful, but event planning is a broader coordination problem involving guests, costs, schedules, supplies, and communication. Partiful's ticketing capabilities also show that financial coordination may become an important competitive issue.

Gabriel Trevino

Sprint 3

Contradiction Memo

Assumptions:

During our first two sprints, we assumed that festivo would make event planning easier by having everything in one application. Our idea was to allow users to create invitations, track RSVps, find vendors, and manage their budgets without having to use multiple websites or apps. We also believed that finding affordable vendors and services was one of the biggest struggles people faced when planning an event.

After completing our three interviews and looking into partiful, we realized that some of our assumptions were not entirely correct. People struggle with different things when planning events, and some of the features we wanted to include are already available in other applications.

My evidence:

In our first interview, the participant talked about helping organize transportation for a family wedding. One of the biggest concerns was the cost of everything rather than finding vendors. This showed us that managing expenses can be a bigger issue for some people.

During our second interview, the participant discussed helping plan a family birthday party. They mentioned having to visit different stores for decorations and using personal contacts to find tables and chairs. I think this interview supported our original idea because having different vendors and services available in one application could make planning an event much easier.

Our third interview brought up a different issue, which was not knowing how many people would actually attend an event. The participant explained that this made it difficult to plan how much food, drinks, and supplies would be needed. This showed us why having RSVP tracking could help people avoid buying too much or not having enough supplies.

Another thing we noticed was that participants used different tools when planning events, including canva to create invitations. When we looked at partiful, we also found that it already allows users to create invitations, manage guests, track RSVps, and even sell tickets. This made us realize that some of the features we originally thought would make festivo different are already being offered by other applications.

Why This Matters:

I think our interviews helped us realize that event planning is not just about finding vendors or creating invitations. There are several things people have to worry about, such as budgeting, attendance, finding supplies, and keeping everything organized. This is important because we originally focused on adding features that we thought people would need. However, our interviews showed us that not everyone struggles with the same problems. We also have to think about how festivo will compete with applications like partiful that already offer similar features. For me, one of the biggest things we need to figure out is what would make someone want to use festivo instead of an application they are already familiar with.

My recommendations:

Based on what we learned, I think we should continue developing festivo as an application that helps people organize their events in one place. However, we should focus more on the features that our interview participants actually mentioned. I believe finding local vendors and services should still be one of our main features. For example, someone planning a birthday party could use festivo to find table and chair rentals, decorations, or other services instead of searching through different websites or asking people for recommendations. We should also keep invitations, RSVP tracking, and basic budgeting features because our interviews showed that these are important parts of event planning. Having an idea of how many guests will attend could also help organizers estimate how much food and supplies they might need. I would leave direct payments and ticket sales out of our MVP for now. Even though partiful offers these features, I think we should focus on making our main features work properly before adding more complicated ones.

My reflection:

Overall, I think our three interviews gave us a better understanding of what people go through when planning events. Some of our original assumptions were correct, but we also learned that people have different priorities depending on the type of event they are organizing.

I still believe Festivo is a good idea, but we need to make sure we are building something people would actually want to use. I think focusing on local vendors, budgeting, and guest coordination could help make festivo more useful while giving us a better idea of what to improve in our next sprint.

Festivo Contradiction Memo

Angel Bautista

Assumption:
One of our core assumptions was that overall the biggest issue in party planning for people is keeping everything organized. We felt as though organization was the main problem that people wanted solved, that a lack of cohesion is what led to the problems that people have with planning. Be it scheduling issues, lack of proper entertainment, vendors being late, etc.

Contradictions:

- One of the main things brought up in Interview One was cost, the cost of attending the wedding, the cost of planning, how payment could be shared to make it easier, and that his use of apps were mainly to drive down the cost (finding the best deal for travel
- Interview Three brought up the issue of attendancy as her major hurdle that there is no guarantee of knowing how many people are actually attending these events versus people who are receiving their invitations.

Implications and Recommended Adjustments:

I think we need to adjust on how specialized our app is, we put in a lot of effort into the vendor side of things and I think it needs to be adjusted to put in a larger focus into the rest of the party planning process, things attendance organization, cost sharing, things of that nature. As it stands now I think were focusing on a problem that isn't the main one that people deal with.

Conclusion:
Our application is too specialized to handle one specific problem and while that problem is important to focus on we should change course to generalize a bit more into various issues that people have in the party planning process. Overall we should take in more inspiration from other apps that do a similar job as we do, such as Partiful's integration of event pages and cost sharing for events.

Miguel Renteria Contradictory Memo Sprint 3: CS5388 10/19/2026

Assumptions

An assumption we had early on for Festivo was that the primary point for the application was to provide an avenue to save money whilst planning an event. This caused an emphasis on price options when searching through vendors and amenities for parties and/or events. The secondary assumption was that a person would be more likely to use an application such as Festivo when it is a convenient alternative to their everyday experience when planning events.

Evidence

We performed 3 interviews which provided ample evidence to support our earlier claims, and provide more context for future details that might become critical in the development of the project. In the first interview, the subject described the expenses being the largest hurdle in the event planning process. However the actual finding of vendors did not appear to be such a prevalent issue, or at least enough of a concern to be mentioned repeatedly, unlike the budgeting concerns. The second interview provided even further support of our second assumption of the concern being a matter of convenience. The interviewee described the process of setting up an event as somewhat primitive, where he just had contacts that could possibly assist in setting up an event, referring to venues, and entertainment. However specifically said that if everything could be acquired and organized within an app, would be very inclined to use that instead. Lastly, the final interviewee mentioned attendance being a big factor in terms of event planning due to the uncertainty of people that might show up, all amounting to unforseen expenses or overspending.

Why this matters:

Depending on general pubic demand and individual's feedback, we have began to understand the most alluring aspects of an event planning application. We determine that not only is there a focus on the budgeting aspect of the app, but also a very noticeable need for an improvement in the convenience of the planning itself. Feedback has very frequently circled around the convenience of being able to plan an entire event in one application, where you can also track the attendance of those attending the event, which allows us to narrow down the more critical aspects of the applications in terms of requirements. These comments also allow us to determine how to stand out from competitor applications in the realm of planning events or parties.

Conclusion

Festivo has a strong foundation of features and an existing market according to feedback, however must focus on the features that the average consumer is looking for. Festivo should stay away from the actual payment process, but retain the planning features with a number of vendor options for convenience purposes. The attendance tracking is also a very sought after feature that is quickly becoming a need at early access, or upon release.